assistance to save one of his Sikh acquaintances, Manmohan Singh, who was living in a farmhouse in the Brijwasan area of South Delhi. Manmohan Singh (not to be confused with Dr Manmohan Singh, who later became PM) had a shipping business in Kolkata and interests in some Hyderabad-based industries. After that Zail Singh ordered his President's Guards to pick up Manmohan Singh and drop him at a safe place in New Delhi.

With the home minister's control over Delhi Police having been taken over by 1 Akbar Road, most senior Delhi police officers were aware of the kind of intervention that the powers-that-be wanted. Only a few brave and conscientious officers from various ranks chose not to pay attention to those signals and carried out their duties as per the law and in right earnest till the very end.

If there was any doubt about the complicity of 1 Akbar Road in what was happening in Delhi and elsewhere, Rajiv Gandhi removed it in his speech at an election rally on 19 November at the Boat Club in New Delhi. 'Some riots took place in the country following the murder of Indira ji,' he said. 'We know the people were very angry and for a few days it seemed that India had been shaken but, when a mighty tree falls it is only natural that the earth around it does shake a little.' [4] In that speech, Rajiv Gandhi trivialized the enormity of the pogrom by describing it as riots, hence sanctifying the use of this word to refer to the horrific events of those days. He also justified the pogrom as a natural outcome of the anger resulting from Indira Gandhi's assassination, overlooked, if not justified, acts of omission and commission by the concerned Delhi police officers, and sent a signal to the many commissions and committees that would inquire into various aspects of the anti-Sikh pogrom in future as to how to weigh the evidence presented before them.

Mob action, police inaction

A three-man SSB guard reached my flat in less than an hour of my conversation with Gary Saxena. Our household help informed us of their arrival. Thanking Sudhir and Hema for providing us refuge in our hour of need, we returned to our flat. The same evening, residents of D-I and D-II flats on Satya Marg and Vinay Marg held a